

WORK ORDER 001

Title

Design Room Knowledge Audit & Documentation Initialization

Objective

Conduct the first knowledge audit for the Design Room.

This Work Order is intended to establish the initial knowledge base by analysing **ONLY** the knowledge contained within this conversation.

Do not attempt to reconstruct unrelated conversations, projects, or memories.

Treat this conversation as the initial source of truth for the Design Room.

Your responsibility is not to archive conversations.

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A. Executive Summary

This first audit establishes the Design Room as a curated knowledge system—not a transcript repository. Its purpose is to convert relevant conversations into concise, reusable documentation that enables future team members to work without needing access to the source discussions.

The conversation provides strong guidance about knowledge governance and documentation practice, but no product, technical, or design-domain decisions yet. The initial knowledge base should therefore focus on:

- The purpose and operating principles of the Design Room.
- A repeatable knowledge-audit workflow.
- A standard Work Order format.
- Rules for selecting, consolidating, classifying, and maintaining knowledge.
- A documentation architecture that separates durable guidance from historical records.
- A clear acceptance test for future documentation.

The principal rule is:

Preserve knowledge, not conversation.

Temporary instructions and conversational phrasing should not become permanent documentation unless they define a repeatable process, decision, or standard.

B. Knowledge Inventory

Classification model

Each extracted item is classified by:

- **Destination:** Where it belongs in the documentation.
- **Stability:**
 - **Stable:** Expected to remain foundational.
 - **Evolving:** Durable in purpose, but likely to be refined.
 - **Operational:** Relevant to a particular execution or record.
- **Reusable value:** Why future contributors need it.

Inventory

D	Knowledge item	Reusable value	Destination	Stability
001	The Design Room is a knowledge system, not a conversation archive.	Establishes the purpose of the system and prevents transcript accumulation.	Principles	Stable
002	Conversations are source material from which reusable knowledge is extracted.	Clarifies the relationship between discussion and documentation.	Principles	Stable
003	Knowledge work should optimise for clarity, reusability, and long-term maintenance rather than	Provides a durable quality standard for all documentation.	Principles / Standards	Stable

	exhaustive preservation.			
↳ J04	Every audit must operate within an explicitly defined source boundary.	Prevents unsupported reconstruction and contamination from unrelated contexts.	Audit Protocol	Stable
↳ J05	External assumptions, unrelated projects, and unavailable conversations must not be treated as evidence.	Protects provenance and reliability.	Audit Protocol	Stable
↳ J06	Long-term knowledge must be separated from temporary discussion and execution details.	Keeps the knowledge base useful and reduces maintenance burden.	Curation Standard	Stable
↳ J07	Duplicated ideas should be merged, redundancy removed, and related concepts consolidated.	Creates coherent documents instead of fragmented notes.	Curation Standard	Stable
↳ J08	Conversational wording should be rewritten into clear documentation unless the exact wording is materially important.	Produces standalone guidance rather than disguised transcripts.	Writing Standard	Stable
↳ J09	Audits should identify decisions, methodologies, workflows, protocols, standards, templates, architectural choices, and collaboration principles.	Supplies a reusable extraction checklist.	Audit Protocol	Evolving
↳ J10	Every extracted item should include its destination, reusable value, and expected stability.	Makes classification and future maintenance explicit.	Classification Standard	Evolving
↳ J11	Documentation must be understandable without access to its source conversation.	Provides a strong acceptance test for documentation quality.	Documentation Standard	Stable
↳ J12	Missing knowledge should be identified and prioritised according to long-term value.	Turns each audit into an input for deliberate knowledge-base development.	Audit Protocol / Planning	Stable
↳ J13	Work should be commissioned through a structured Work Order containing a title, objective, scope, deliverables, principles, output, and success definition.	Creates a repeatable way to assign bounded documentation work.	Templates / Work Orders	Evolving
↳ J14	Work Order 001 is the initialization record for the Design Room's knowledge base.	Preserves provenance and explains why the initial documentation is governance-focused.	Work Order Records	Operational
↳ J15	Documentation architecture should distinguish normative guidance, reusable procedures, decisions, reusable assets, research, and historical execution records.	Prevents documents with different purposes and lifecycles from being mixed together.	Information Architecture	Evolving
↳ J16	This conversation contains no substantive product, technical, visual-design, research, or system-architecture decisions.	Prevents absence of evidence from being mistaken for undocumented decisions.	Audit Record / Gap Register	Operational
↳ J17	The documentation structure offered in a Work Order is illustrative, not mandatory; auditors may recommend a better structure.	Allows the knowledge architecture to evolve based on actual needs.	Architecture Principle	Stable

Long-term knowledge

Items K-001 through K-013, K-015, and K-017 should become maintained documentation. They establish enduring principles, protocols, and standards.

Operational records

Items K-014 and K-016 belong in the record of this audit. They provide provenance but are not general rules.

Excluded material

The following should not be promoted into durable Design Room knowledge:

- The conversational form of this request.
- Repeated statements that express the same underlying principle.
- Example folder names when they do not represent an adopted structure.
- Runtime or workspace details unrelated to the Design Room's knowledge model.
- Any inferred product, team, design, or technical context not stated here.

C. Proposed Documentation Structure



```

Design Room/
├── README.md
├──
├── 01-principles/
│   ├── design-room-charter.md
│   └── knowledge-quality-principles.md
├──
├── 02-protocols/
│   ├── knowledge-audit-protocol.md
│   ├── knowledge-classification-protocol.md
│   └── documentation-maintenance-protocol.md
├──
├── 03-standards/
│   ├── documentation-standard.md
│   ├── naming-and-organization-standard.md
│   └── provenance-standard.md
├──
├── 04-workflows/
│   └── conversation-to-knowledge-workflow.md
├──
├── 05-decisions/
│   ├── README.md
│   └── decision-record-template.md
├──
├── 06-templates/
│   ├── work-order-template.md
│   ├── knowledge-audit-template.md
│   └── documentation-page-template.md
├──
├── 07-research/
│   └── README.md
├──
├── 08-registers/
│   ├── knowledge-inventory.md
│   └── documentation-gap-register.md
├──
└── 09-records/
    ├── work-orders/
    │   └── WO-001-knowledge-audit-initialization.md
    ├── audit-records/
    │   └── initial-conversation-audit.md
    └──
    
```

Structural rationale

Principles

Defines enduring beliefs and boundaries. These documents should change rarely.

Protocols

Defines required procedures, such as how to conduct an audit or classify knowledge. Protocols may mature through use.

Standards

Defines quality requirements that documentation must satisfy. Standards answer “what good looks like.”

Workflows

Provides practical sequences for repeatable activities. A workflow implements one or more protocols.

Decisions

Records consequential choices and their rationale. Decision records should not be silently rewritten when circumstances change; later decisions should supersede them explicitly.

Templates

Contains reusable starting structures. Templates improve consistency without turning every document into a rigid form.

Research

Contains evidence and findings that may support later decisions. Research should remain distinct from adopted policy.

Registers

Provides navigational inventories, ownership information, maintenance status, and known gaps.

Records

Contains completed Work Orders and audit outcomes. Records provide provenance but are not automatically normative guidance.

Recommended document status labels

Every maintained document should carry one of these statuses:

- **Draft:** Proposed but not adopted.
- **Active:** Current guidance.
- **Superseded:** Retained for history but replaced.
- **Archived:** No longer operationally relevant.

Where useful, documents should also identify an owner, adoption date, and next review date. These fields are recommended but cannot yet be fully defined because ownership and governance have not been established.

D. Documentation Drafts

Draft 1 — Design Room Charter

Draft 2 — Knowledge Audit Protocol

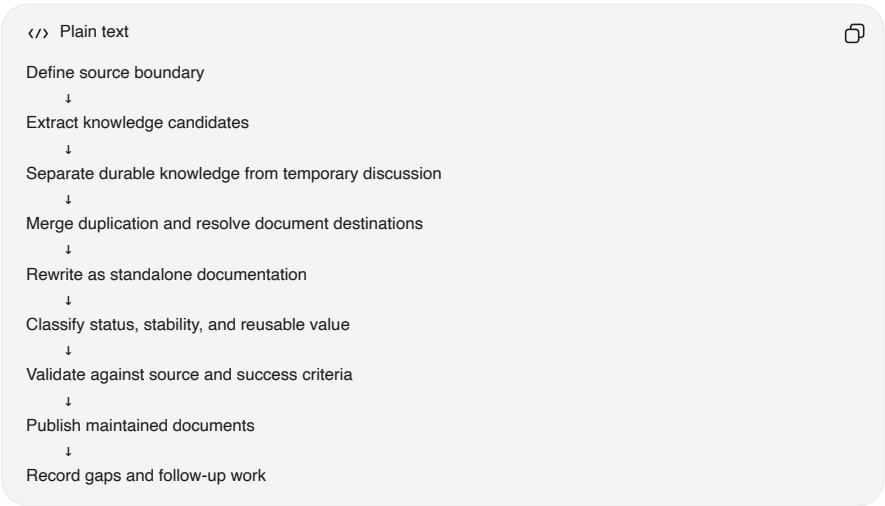
Draft 3 — Work Order Template

Initial decision record

DR-001 — Establish the Design Room as a curated knowledge system

- **Status:** Proposed for adoption through Work Order 001.
- **Decision:** The Design Room will store reusable knowledge rather than conversation archives.
- **Rationale:** Transcripts preserve chronology but require readers to rediscover meaning. Curated documentation makes principles, decisions, and working methods directly usable.
- **Consequences:**
 - Conversations are treated as inputs, not final artifacts.
 - Audits require selection, rewriting, consolidation, and classification.
 - Some source material will intentionally not be retained.
 - Provenance should be preserved through concise records rather than complete transcripts.
- **Stability:** Stable.
- **Revisit when:** The Design Room’s audience, governance model, or primary purpose materially changes.

Initial conversation-to-knowledge workflow



E. Missing Knowledge & Recommended Next Steps

Priority 1 — Establish governance

The Design Room currently has principles but no defined authority model. Document:

- Who may adopt or change standards.
- Who owns each document.
- How proposals become active guidance.
- How conflicting documentation is resolved.
- How documents are superseded or archived.
- How often active guidance is reviewed.

This has the highest long-term value because all future documentation will depend on it.

Recommended follow-up: Work Order 002 — Design Room Governance and Document Lifecycle.

Priority 2 — Define the information architecture in practice

The proposed structure needs validation against real material. Document:

- Naming conventions.
- Required document metadata.
- Rules for selecting a document type.
- Whether folders, tags, links, or indexes provide navigation.
- How cross-cutting topics should be handled.
- When a document should be divided or consolidated.

Recommended follow-up: Work Order 003 — Documentation Architecture and Metadata Standard.

Priority 3 — Define decision management

A basic decision-record model has been proposed, but the following remain undefined:

- Which decisions require formal records.
- Who approves them.
- How alternatives and dissent are represented.
- How later decisions supersede earlier ones.
- How implementation outcomes feed back into decisions.

Recommended follow-up: Work Order 004 — Decision Record Protocol.

Priority 4 — Create a source and provenance standard

Future audits may use several conversations, research documents, or project artifacts. The Design Room needs rules covering:

- Source attribution.
- Confidence and uncertainty.
- Conflicting sources.
- Evidence dates.
- Unsupported claims.
- Separation of research findings from adopted decisions.

Recommended follow-up: Work Order 005 — Provenance and Evidence Standard.

Priority 5 — Document the Design Room’s actual working domain

This conversation defines how knowledge should be managed, but not what the Design Room designs or supports. Future documentation should clarify:

- Mission and intended outcomes.
- Team and audience.
- Scope of design activity.
- Product or service context.
- Core vocabulary.
- Current systems and constraints.
- Collaboration with adjacent teams.

This should be documented only when an authoritative source becomes available.

Priority 6 — Test the protocol on substantive material

The audit method should be exercised on a future bounded source containing actual design work. The test should evaluate:

- Whether the classification model is sufficient.
- Whether the proposed folders match real retrieval needs.
- Whether audits preserve necessary rationale.
- Whether documentation remains concise.
- Whether a new contributor can successfully use the output.

Recommended initialization sequence

1. Adopt or revise the Design Room Charter.
2. Establish governance and lifecycle rules.
3. Confirm the documentation architecture and metadata standard.
4. Adopt the audit and classification protocols.
5. Create the initial registers and templates.
6. Run a second audit against the next explicitly authorised source.
7. Review the architecture after several real documents exist.

Until additional authoritative material is supplied, no product, design, technical, or team-specific decisions should be inferred.